



2–2.4 m
6½–7¾ ft

CRABEATER SEAL
Lobodon carcinophaga
Despite its name, this agile Antarctic seal eats mainly krill, which it filters from the water, using specially modified teeth.



2–2.7 m
6½–8¾ ft

inflatable muzzle of male

HOODED SEAL
Cystophora cristata
This solitary, Arctic seal has an unusual, inflatable nose that droops over its mouth. The pups become independent at just five days old.

2.1–4 m
7–13 ft



3–5 m
10–16 ft

SOUTHERN ELEPHANT SEAL
Mirounga leonina
The huge male of this Southern Ocean species has a trunk-like nose and is the largest carnivore, weighing up to 3,000 kg (6,610 lb).



NORTHERN ELEPHANT SEAL
Mirounga angustirostris

This is a large seal of the North Pacific. The male has a long, trunk-like nose. Like its southern relative, it was almost hunted to extinction, but is now recovering.



1.5–1.8 m
5–6 ft

SPOTTED SEAL
Phoca largha
This small seal is mainly found on ice floes off the northern coasts of Siberia and Yukon, Canada. Adults form stable pairs in order to breed.

large eyes set back on head

1.2–2 m
4–6½ ft



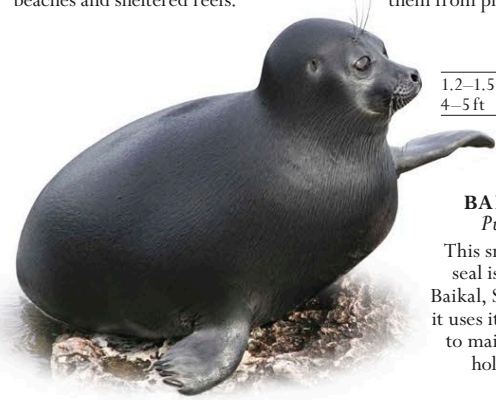
spots, rings, and blotches on body



1.1–1.6 m
3½–5¼ ft

COMMON SEAL
Phoca vitulina
Also known as the harbour seal, this dainty seal is widespread along temperate coasts. It hauls on to sandy beaches and sheltered reefs.

RINGED SEAL
Pusa hispida
This small seal mainly inhabits Arctic ice shelves. Pups are born in lairs beneath the ice to protect them from predators.



1.2–1.5 m
4–5 ft

BAIKAL SEAL
Pusa sibirica
This small, freshwater seal is found in Lake Baikal, Siberia. In winter, it uses its teeth and claws to maintain breathing holes in the ice.



1.5 m
5 ft

CASPIAN SEAL
Pusa caspica
About 100,000 of this small species live in the Caspian Sea. Unusually, the male is believed to take only one mate, without fighting off other males.